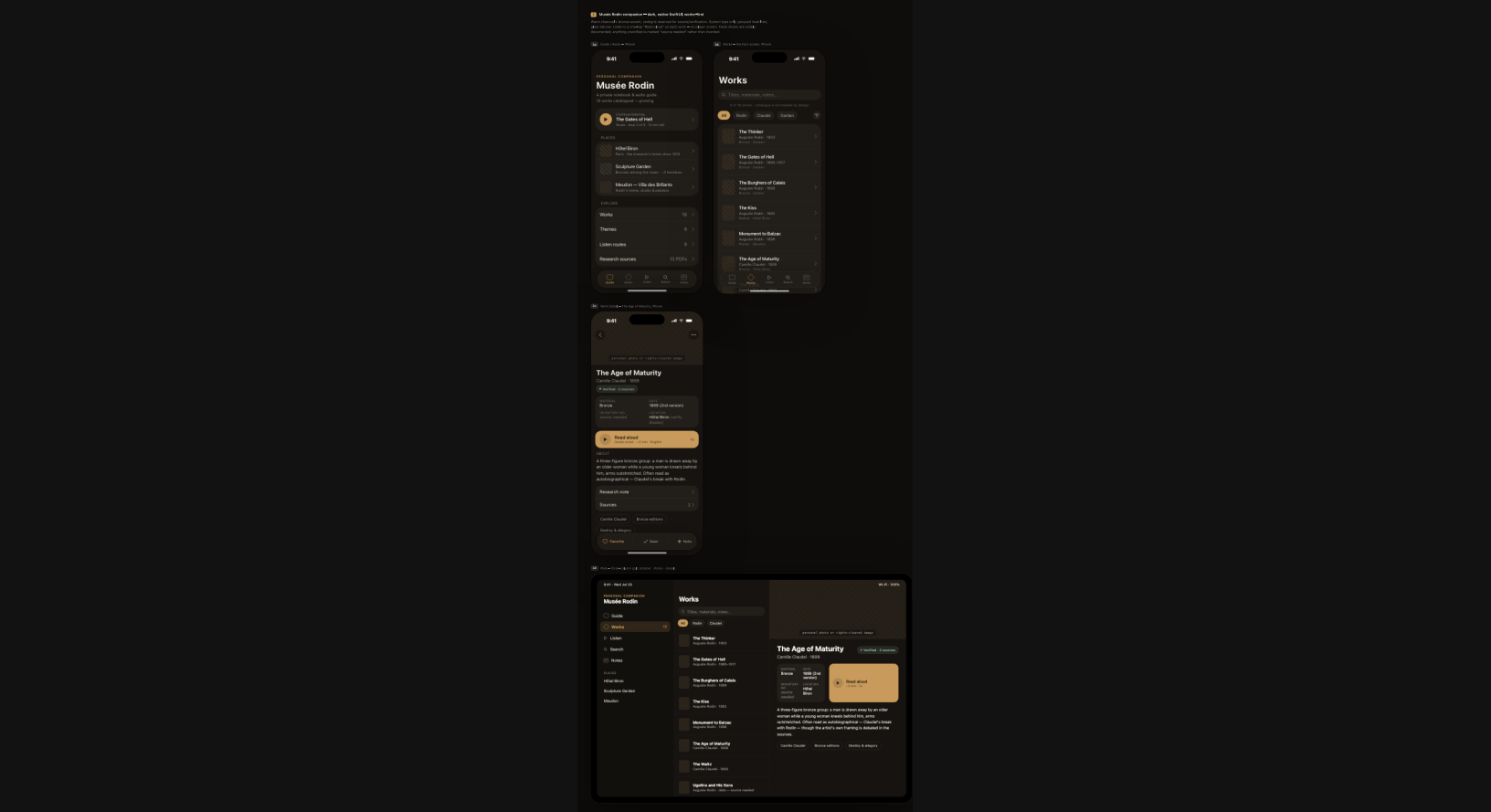

Musée Rodin companion — dark, warm (bronze), sparse
Guide / Home — iPhone
9:41
PERSONAL COMPANION
Musée Rodin
A private notebook & audio guide
19 works catalogued — growing
Continue listening
The Gates of Hell
Works — stop 3 of 8 · 14 min left
PLACES
Hôtel Biron
Paris · the museum's home since 1919
Sculpture Garden
Bronzes among the roses · 6 hectares
Meudon — Villa des Brillants
Rodin's home, studio & atelier
EXPLORE
Works 18
Themes 9
Listen routes 9
Research sources 13 PDFs
Guide
Works
Listen
Search
Notes
Works — Dashed screen, iPhone
9:41
Works
Titles, materials, notes…
3 of 18 shown · catalogue is incomplete by design
All
Rodin
Claudel
Garden
The Thinker
Auguste Rodin · 1903
Bronze · Garden
The Gates of Hell
Auguste Rodin · 1880–1917
Bronze · Garden
The Burghers of Calais
Auguste Rodin · 1889
Bronze · Garden
The Kiss
Auguste Rodin · 1882
Marble · Hôtel Biron
Monument to Balzac
Auguste Rodin · 1898
Plaster · Meudon
The Age of Maturity
Camille Claudel · 1899
Bronze · Hôtel Biron
Work Detail — The Age of Maturity, iPhone
9:41
personal photo or rights-cleared image
The Age of Maturity
Camille Claudel · 1899
✦ Verified · 2 sources
MATERIAL
Bronze
EDITION
1899 (2nd version)
LOCATION
Hôtel Biron
Read aloud
Guide script · 4 min · English
ABOUT
A three-figure bronze group: a man is drawn away by an older woman while a young woman kneels behind him, arms outstretched. Often read as autobiographical — Claudel's break with Rodin.
Research note
Sources 2
Camille Claudel
Bronze editions
Destiny & allegory
Favorite
Seen
Note
iPad — Dark, Bronze & Warm Stone
9:41 · Wed Jul 23
Wi-Fi · 100%
PERSONAL COMPANION
Musée Rodin
Guide
Works 18
Listen
Search
Notes
PLACES
Hôtel Biron
Sculpture Garden
Meudon
Works
Titles, materials, notes…
All
Rodin
Claudel
The Thinker
Auguste Rodin · 1903
The Gates of Hell
Auguste Rodin · 1880–1917
The Burghers of Calais
Auguste Rodin · 1889
The Kiss
Auguste Rodin · 1882
Monument to Balzac
Auguste Rodin · 1898
The Age of Maturity
Camille Claudel · 1899
The Waltz
Camille Claudel · 1905
Ugolino and His Sons
Auguste Rodin · date — source needed
personal photo or rights-cleared image
The Age of Maturity
Camille Claudel · 1899
✦ Verified · 2 sources
MATERIAL
Bronze
EDITION
1899 (2nd version)
LOCATION
Hôtel Biron
Read aloud
Guide script · 4 min
A three-figure bronze group: a man is drawn away by an older woman while a young woman kneels behind him, arms outstretched. Often read as autobiographical — Claudel's break with Rodin — though the artist's own framing is debated in the sources.
Camille Claudel
Bronze editions
Destiny & allegory
Design document — mission, users, nav map, specs, all in EN/FR
DESIGN DOCUMENT · JULY 2026
Musée Rodin Companion — iOS / iPadOS
A personal, scenic-themed guide to the Musée Rodin collection. Not a PDF library, not a marketing app: a quiet notebook where extracted research becomes readable, listenable knowledge.
1 · Concept & rationale
Works browsing is the hero. Everything routes through the work record: places, themes and routes are just curated views onto the same catalogue. PDFs are source material only — they surface as citation chips and a Sources sheet, never as a document shelf.
Honesty is a design feature. Every fact field can be in one of three states: verified (with sources), unverified ("source needed", shown in tertiary italic), or absent. The catalogue openly states it is incomplete ("18 works — growing"). No object had to ever invented to fill a layout.
Listen is deliberately simple. One "Read aloud" action per work/topic, backed by AVSpeechSynthesizer reading the extracted guide script. No custom player screen — playback, a speed toggle (1× / 1.25× / 0.8×) in the button itself, and the transcript is simply the text already on screen. Routes are ordered lists of works; "listening a route" is just reading stop after stop.
Calm by default, depth on-demand. Screens show the short visitor description first; "Research note" and "Sources" are collapsed disclosure rows. Advanced filters live behind the filter button, not in the default chrome.
2 · Visual system & tokens (dark)
bg · canvas #1A1A18
bg · card #2A2A28
bg · field/ivory #E8E4DC
text / #F4EEE1 / 94% / 62%
accent · bronze #C9A96E
accent · patina #6F9B8E
Roles. Bronze is the single interactive tint (buttons, active tab, selection). Patina is reserved exclusively for source/verification meaning — it never decorates. Separators are label at 8%. Both accents sit near the same OKLCH lightness/chroma so neither shouts.
Typography — system only. SF Pro via Dynamic Type text styles: Large Title 34/700 · Title1 22/700 · Title2 20/600 · Title3 18/600 · Headline 17/600 · Body 17/400 · Subheadline 15 · Footnote 13 · Caption 12 & 11. Never below Caption2. Italic text never below Subheadline.
Spacing & radii. 4 / 8 / 12 / 16 / 20 / 32 — screen gutter 16, card padding 16, section gap 18–24. Radii 8 (thumbnails) · 10 (small tiles) · 16–20 (cards) · 28 (grouped lists) · pill (chips, tab bar, buttons). Hairlines 0.5 px. Icons SF Symbols at 17 / 22 / 28 pt, weight matching the adjacent text. Hit targets ≥ 44 pt.
Motion & haptics. No decorative motion. Standard NavigationStack push/pop/swipe transitions only; disclosure rows animate with the default spring. Haptics: .impact(.light) on Favorite/Seen toggle, .selection on filter chips, .success and .warning on Read aloud start/stop.
3 · Navigation map
Guide (tab)
• Places list
• Theme list
• Work detail
Works (tab)
• Work Detail
• Filter sheet
• Sources sheet
Listen (tab)
• Route (ordered)
• Stop detail
• Work detail + Read aloud
Search (tab)
• grouped results
• any record
Notes (tab)
• Note editor
• Work
• linked item/chips
All tabs converge on Work Detail — one canonical record, one NavigationStack per tab. Sheets: Filters, Note editor, Sources never push. Deep links: any work/place/theme/route/note has a stable id, so Spotlight, Handoff and widgets can target it.
4 · Screen specs
Guide / Home (1a) — notebook opening, not a landing page. Continue-listening card (only when a route is mid-progress), Places, Explore. No imagery required; striped placeholders until personal photos exist.
Works (1b) — search field, one row of primary chips (All · Rodin · Claudel · Garden) + filter button opening a sheet with the full facet set (sculpture, drawing, correspondence, photograph; garden, Meudon, material, sale/unsold). Rows: thumbnail · title · artist · date · material/location · No-confidence-indicator here — kept for detail, per decision. Footer states the incidental count.
Work Detail (1c) — image (optional), title block, verification chip, fact grid (unverified fields show "source needed"), bronze Read aloud card with inline speed, short About, collapsed Research note & Sources, theme chips, bottom action bar (Favorite / Seen / Note).
Listen — a list of route cards (Highlights, Garden, Hôtel Biron, Meudon, Camille Claudel, The Gates of Hell, Balzac, Drawings, Bronze Editions), each showing stop count, est. minutes, progress. A route is an ordered list of work rows with stop numbers; tapping a stop opens Work Detail and offers Read aloud. No dedicated player screen.
Search — one field, results grouped Work / Topic / Source / Note with section headers; source hits show the PDF title + page and open the cited passage, not the whole PDF.
Notes — segmented control: Notes · Favorites · Seen. Note cards show excerpt + linked record chip. Empty state: "Notes you add on any work appear here." Visitor info, if ever added, carries an "as of <date> — check museum visit info" caveat line.
5 · Component inventory
WorkRow — 76 pt, thumb 48×48 rt, title Headline, artist-date Footnote, material Caption. Swipe: Favorite / Seen.
WorkDetailHeader — optional image, title Title1, artist-date Subheadline, VerificationChip.
VerificationChip — ✦ Verified · N sources / Source needed / Unverified.
VerificationKey — patina dot + "Verified = sourced; ceramic: "Partially sourced", "Source needed" (tertiary, no dot).
CitationChip — patina-outline pill: source short name + page; tap → cited passage sheet.
ReadAloudCard — bronze card: play/stop, script length, inline speed cycle. The only audio UI in the app.
RouteCard — title, stop count, minutes, title progress bar (bronze).
NotesCard — excerpt (body, linked record chip, date Caption.
FilterChips + FilterSheet — chips for primary facets; sheet for the rest, with active-count badge on the filter button.
ThumbPlaceholder — 45° stripe on bg-tertiary, monospace caption naming the needed asset.
EmptyState — one symbol, one sentence, optional single action. Never illustrated, never jokey.
6 · Accessibility
Two kinds of speech, clearly separated. Apple VoiceOver reads the UI; the app's Read-aloud narrates guide scripts. The Read-aloud button's VoiceOver label is "Read guide script aloud, about 2 minutes" — so a VoiceOver user knows it starts content narration, not screen reading. Read-aloud pauses when VoiceOver focus moves to it, and is exposed as a toggle button with value "playing / stopped".
Per screen. Home: sections are accessibility containers; Continue card label "Resume route, The Gates of Hell, stop 3 of 8". Works: each row is one element — "The Thinker, Auguste Rodin, 1903, bronze, in the garden. Button"; chips are toggle buttons with selected state; filter button announces active-filter count. Detail: heading trait on the title, fact grid read as label-value pairs ("Inventory number: source needed"); focus order title → verification → facts → read-aloud → about → disclosures → actions; favorite announces "Added to favorites" via UIAccessibility notification. Search: results announce group headers. All toggles report state; all targets ≥ 44 pt.
System settings honored: full Dynamic Type (rows grow, grids reflow to one column at accessibility sizes), dark-only palette tested at 7:1 for body text, Increase Contrast swaps 60% secondary to 78%, Reduce Motion is already the default posture, Reduce Transparency replaces the glass tab bar with solid bg-card.
7 · iPhone ⇔ iPad
One adaptive design (1d): compact width uses TabView + push navigation; regular width uses NavigationSplitView (sidebar list · detail). Same components, wider fact grid. Read-aloud card moves beside the facts. Slide Over/split screen collapses back to the compact layout. State (selection, filters, playback position) survives size-class changes.
8 · MVP scope
Build first
Works list + filters (chips only) · Work Detail with fact states & citations · Read-aloud via AVSpeechSynthesizer · Favorite / Seen / plain-text notes · Home with Places & Explore · the 18 starter works, hand-extracted.
Postpone
Full-text search across PDF extractions · Listen routes & progress · Themes browsing · iPad sheet hands · iPad three-column polish · cited-passage viewer · Images & rights workflow · visitor info.
Try next: Hook the Listen routes screen (1c) → Works (1b) at an accessibility text size → Try a later-catchment variant of (1a).